



UCL Undergraduate Mathematics Colloquium

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Date: 7thth October 2026, Time: 3-4pm

Location: B20, Jevons Lecture Theatre, Drayton House

Fake integers and Fermat's last theorem

Speaker: Dr Selim Ghazouani (UCL)

Abstract: Fermat's last theorem was for about three centuries one of the most resistant open problems in mathematics which was solved during the 1990s.

It states that the equation $x^n + y^n = z^n$ has no non-obvious solutions (x, y, z) when n is larger or equal to 3 (an *obvious* solution is one where one of x, y or z equals 0).

We will discuss how a fruitful (but eventually unsuccessful) attempt to proving it led mathematicians from the late 19th century to introduce the notion of what we will call a *fake integer*.

Colloquium Website

